



Introduction to Architecture Standards

Architecture standards provide a common language and a proven method based on leading practice and industry knowledge. There are many architect standards; some are designed for use in particular industry verticals and some for general use. TOGAF, ArchiMate, and IT4IT Standards are vendor-neutral, open standards from The Open Group.

Types of architects

There are two types of architects and levels of expertise.

- Enterprise architect: An enterprise architect is concerned with the whole organization
- Domain architect: A domain architect specializes in a particular layer or topic

What happens without architecture standards?

- Variation in approach. People will find different ways to solve the problems that they face in IT and business management.
 - Silos quickly form. The business and technology areas of the organization become misaligned.
 - Governance becomes impossible. There is no defined set of principles to guide decision making.
 - Confusion arises. People have different definitions for the same concepts.
 - Time is wasted and work is redone. Teams have difficulty communicating and using each other's work.
 - No single, unified view of the enterprise. Strategic thinking becomes impossible, and only tactical responses can be made.
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QUICK REFERENCE GUIDE

Architecture standards

The following standards are vendor-neutral, open standards from The Open Group. They work across all industry verticals and can be applied to any project.

- **TOGAF:** A framework and methodology for enterprise architecture
- **ArchiMate:** A modeling notation that can be used with TOGAF
- **IT4IT:** A reference architecture and approach to IT operations management

Key points

- Standards offer an authoritative, objective, and reproducible way to undertake enterprise architecture projects
- Clear architecture artifacts help to support the business case for transformation and enable communication between technical and business teams
- Architecture can help our customers to think on a platform-scale, rather than a tool scale, helping us to move them from a change mindset to a transformation mindset
- Using standards helps to formalize your customer's thinking, bringing rigor to solution design and implementation. By finding and addressing gaps, and by enabling different options to be safely explored, you can help to accelerate change programs and ensure success